

COVID Leader Perceptions - Vaccine Hoarding (#88837)

Created: 02/22/2022 06:09 AM (PT)

Public: 08/15/2023 08:17 AM (PT)

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1) Have any data been collected for this study already?

No, no data have been collected for this study yet.

2) What's the main question being asked or hypothesis being tested in this study?

We are asking whether support for global distribution of vaccines (vs. support for hoarding in the home country) enhances trust in leaders. We hypothesize that public trust will be greater for leaders who argue that governments should distribute vaccines globally to achieve the greatest good (vs. keep them in the home country to fulfill a duty to protect citizens).

3) Describe the key dependent variable(s) specifying how they will be measured.

After reading a short introduction to the vaccine distribution dilemma and potential policies, participants will be asked to imagine that the mayor of a major city in their region is arguing in support of either distribution or hoarding. They will then be asked to report their general trust in the leader ("How trustworthy do you think this person is?"), and their trust in the leader's advice on other issues ("How likely would you be to trust this person's advice on other issues?"), both to be answered on a 1-7 scale. Our main dependent variable will be the average response to these two questions, computed separately for each participant.

4) How many and which conditions will participants be assigned to?

Participants will be randomly and blindly assigned to read either a distribution or a hoarding argument.

5) Specify exactly which analyses you will conduct to examine the main question/hypothesis.

To examine participants' trust in the leaders, we will conduct a linear mixed-effects model of the effect of argument type (distribution vs. hoarding) on the composite score of trust, with demographic variables (namely gender, age, race, education, subjective SES, political ideology, and religiosity) and policy support as fixed factors, and country as random factor. In the case of convergence or singularity issues, we will simplify the model by reducing the complexity of the random effects structure. We will follow up on significant effects with post-hoc comparisons using Bonferroni corrections.

6) Describe exactly how outliers will be defined and handled, and your precise rule(s) for excluding observations.

We will exclude subjects who:

- Participate more than once (as determined via their IP address and platform ID)
- Fail one or both attention checks at the beginning of the experiment
- Report residing in a country different from the one of intended recruitment
- Do not answer more than 50% of key questions (i.e., more than 6 questions)
- Fail an attention check regarding the question they were asked about the mayor

7) How many observations will be collected or what will determine sample size? No need to justify decision, but be precise about exactly how the number will be determined.

We will recruit a sample of 500 participants in each of the following countries: Australia, Canada, United Kingdom, and United States of America - for a total of 2000 participants. This sample size proved sufficient to achieve 99% power to detect our main effect of interest in pilot data. We aim to recruit samples that are nationally representative with respect to age and gender in each country, although these quotas may be relaxed after 2 weeks.

8) Anything else you would like to pre-register? (e.g., secondary analyses, variables collected for exploratory purposes, unusual analyses planned?)

In addition to the main DVs above, we will collect some information about the participants such as their vaccination status, moral judgments of vaccine distribution policies, concerns about the consequences of COVID, attitudes toward COVID vaccines and their distribution, attitudes toward government responses to COVID, social desirability tendencies (SDR), utilitarianism tendencies (OUS), nationalistic and patriotic tendencies, as well as some debriefing questions.

We will also run a series of secondary analyses exploring how the effects of argument on trust in leaders might interact with factors such as policy support, political ideology, and the various individual difference scores listed above (e.g., OUS, SDR, vaccination status, etc.).